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Our ref GJT/CGD/P51709EP

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ONLINE FILING

Re: European Patent Application No. 22716486.0
Novartis AG

In response to communication pursuant to Rule 161(1) and 162 EPC dated 27 October 2023 and the written opinion of the International Searching Authority, an amended set of claims is enclosed.

Amendments

The amended set of claims are provided in re-typed and marked-up formats.

There are now 22 claims. The 7 excess claims fees are being paid as set out in the attached fee sheet. Should the excess claims fees not be received, or should there be a shortfall, the EPO is authorised to debit the necessary amount from our deposit account (No. 2805.0051, Elkington and Fife LLP).

Basis for the amended claims can be found in the application as originally filed as shown in the marked-up version of the claims, and is summarised in the table below:

Claim	Basis in the application as filed
1	Claims 1 and 92
2	Claims 2 and 93
3	Claims 3 and 94
4	Claim 177
5	Claim 178
6	Claims 4-8, 95-99, and 179-183
7	Claims 9, 100, 184, 278, 283, and 288
8	Claims 10, 101, 185, 279, 284, and 289
9	Claims 11, 102, 186, 280, 285, and 290
10	Claims 12, 103, 187, 281, 286, and 291
11	Claims 13, 104, 188, 282, 287, and 292
12	Claims 14-18, 105-109, and 189-197
13	Claims 19-23, 110-114, and 198-202
14	Claims 24-33, 115-122, and 203-219
15	Claims 24-37 and 220-223
16	Claims 38-46, 123-131, and 224-232
17	Claims 47-61, 132-146, and 233-247
18	Claims 62-76, 147-161, and 248-262
19	Claims 77, 162, and 263
20	Claims 78-86, 163-171, and 264-272

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21	Claims 87-90, 172-175, and 273-276
22	Claims 91, 176, and 277

Any subject-matter matter that may have been deleted is not abandoned, and the applicant reserves the right to reinstate it in the current application or in one or more divisional applications, in the future.

In response to the ISA's request in the written opinion, the method of treatment claims are now formulated as medical use claims.

General

The applicant requests a future opportunity to amend the description to agree with the claims, and to comply with other formal requirements, once it has been indicated that the claims are allowable.

As a precaution at this early stage, oral proceedings are requested should any division of the EPO be minded to refuse the application without providing the applicant a further opportunity to respond in writing.

Yours faithfully
Elkington and Fife LLP

[Signed Electronically]

Glyn Truscott

Enc. Amended claims (re-typed and marked-up formats)